

1970 British Cohort Study

Age 16 School type derived variable

User Guide (Version 1)

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For data queries, please contact help@ukdataservice.ac.uk.

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The UCL Centre for Longitudinal Studies (CLS) is an Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC) Resource Centre based at University College London. It manages four internationally-renowned cohort studies: the 1958 National Child Development Study, the 1970 British Cohort Study, Next Steps, and the Millennium Cohort Study. For more information, visit www.cls.ucl.ac.uk.

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About the 1970 British Cohort Study

The 1970 British Cohort Study (BCS70) is a longitudinal birth cohort study, following a nationally representative sample of over 16,000 people born in Britain in a single week in April 1970.

We have surveyed cohort members throughout their childhood and adult lives, mapping their individual trajectories and creating a unique resource for researchers. It is one of very few longitudinal studies following people of this generation anywhere in the world.

Featuring a range of objective measures and rich self-reported data, BCS70 covers an incredible amount of ground and can be used in research on many topics

Evidence from BCS70 has illuminated important issues for our society across five decades. Key findings include how reading for pleasure matters for children's cognitive development, why grammar schools have not reduced social inequalities, and how childhood experiences can impact on mental health in mid-life.

Every day researchers from across the scientific community are using this important study to make new connections and discoveries.

1. Introduction

This User Guide describes the dataset of the enhanced school type derived variable of the 1970 British Cohort Study (BCS70).

The 1986 school type variable shows the type of secondary school the cohort member (CM) attended at age 16. Due to a teachers' strike in 1986, the BCS 1986 schools level data, taken from the head teacher's questionnaire, was only populated for 40% of cohort members who participated in sweep 4. This school type variable is available to access in its original form (STYPE) in the BCS70 sweep 4 deposit '1970 British Cohort Study: Age 16, Sweep 4 Head Teacher Questionnaire, 1986'.

In 2017, the 1986 school type variable was enhanced using two additional sources of school type data: the Schools Census data and the Age 42 Sweep recall data. This enhanced school type variable (BD4STYPE) was included in the derived variables dataset of the main BCS70 sweep 4 deposit '1970 British Cohort Study: Age 16, Sweep 4, 1986'.

However, BD4STYPE was derived only for the 11,615 sweep 4 cohort members. To improve the coverage of this variable, it has been re-derived to cover the entire cohort. This updated derived variable, named BDSTYPE, covers the 18,036 eligible members in the BCS70 cohort. Of these 12,358 (69%) have a derived school type, and 86% of sweep 4 respondents, more than twice as many as originally available.

2. The full-cohort school type derived variable

2.1 Data sources

The new derived variable (BDSTYPE) shows the type of secondary school the cohort member (CM) attended at age 16 using three sources of information:

- Head Teacher Questionnaire in 1986 (STYPE),
- Retrospective question put to the CM in 2012 at age 42 sweep (B9SC16TP)
- The School type data extracted from the 1986 School Census, not deposited at the UKDS.

Source	Variable description	Data source	Sweep	UKDS dataset
STYPE	Type of school attended	BCS70 Head Teacher Questionnaire	Sweep 4 (Age 16)	bcs70_htq
B9SC16TP	Type of school attended at age 16	BCS70 main questionnaire	Sweep 9 (Age 42)	bcs70_2012_flatfile
Schools' Census data	n/a	1986 School Census	n/a	n/a

For the link to the BCS70 to the Schools' Census 1986, name and address information from both the age 42 survey and the scanned BCS70 documents were used. There are 10,224 cases for which at least one of the scanned documents providing school names and school addresses and/or child addresses is available. Of these, 8,597 relate to individuals in England and could be matched to Schools in the Census, and from this their school type could ultimately be determined.

2.2 Derivation: order of precedence

Following inspection of the distribution of responses across the three sources and the level of agreement between these sources, the following order of precedence was proposed:

- If only one source of information existed, this would obviously be used.
- If there were two or three sources and there was discrepancy, the order of preference was as follows:
 1. The Head Teacher response at age 16
 2. The Census data
 3. The CM's retrospective response at age 42

In addition, reliability has been cross-checked between the three data sources where possible

2.3 Derivation: pseudo code

The steps taken to deriving the school type variable are provided in the pseudo code below.

Variable assignment and recoding

census (derived from School Census data: (1=1) (2=2) (3=3) (4=4) (5=5) (6=6) (7=7) (8=8) (else=-1))

head (derived from stype: (1=1) (2=4) (3=2) (4=5) (5=3) (6=6) (7=3) (8=7) (else=-1))

recall (derived from b9sc16tp: (1=1) (2=2) (3,4=3) (5=4) (6=5) (7=6) (8=7) (else=-1))

final_type (final school type value initialised to -1)

Order of precedence

If *head* is not missing, set *final_type* to *head*

IF (NOTMISSING(*head*)) THEN *final_type* = *head*

If *final_type* is either missing or 'other' (7) and *census* is not missing, set *final_type* to *census*

IF (MISSING(*final_type*) or *final_type* = 7) and NOTMISSING(*census*)) THEN
final_type = *census*

If *final_type* is either missing or 'other' (7) and *recall* is not missing, set *final_type* to *recall*

IF (MISSING(*final_type*) or *final_type* = 7) and NOTMISSING(*recall*)) THEN
final_type = *recall*

Populate derived variable

bdstype=*final_type*

3. Licencing and Data access

Dataset and location

The newly enhanced school type derived variable BDSTYPE has been made available via the UKDS under End User Licence (EUL) as a standalone dataset with file name *bcs70_age16_school_type*.

Variable name	Variable label	Dataset
BDSTYPE	School Type Age 16 for full cohort (derived from STYPE, B9SC16TP and 1986 School Census)	<i>bcs70_age16_school_type</i> .

As of July 2022, the dataset is available within both the age 16 and age 42 main survey data:

- 1970 British Cohort Study: Age 16, Sweep 4, 1986
- 1970 British Cohort Study: Age 42, Sweep 9, 2012

Licencing

All users of the EUL data need to be registered with the UKDS. Details of how to do this are available at <https://www.ukdataservice.ac.uk/get-data/how-toaccess/registration>. This dataset can be downloaded once the End User Licence access conditions have been accepted by the user.

Related BCS70 data changes

The previous sweep 4-only version (BD4STYPE) has now been removed from the data.

In addition, the following variables has been re-labelled as follows:

Variable name	Variable label	Dataset
STYPE	Type of school attended (NB: full cohort DV in main bcs4 deposit)	bcs70_htq
B9SC16TP	Type of school attended at age 16 (NB: full cohort DV in separate dataset)	bcs70_2012_flatfile